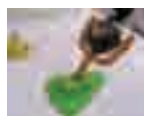




Be a HeadCase

An iPod skin that can open bottles! It's an actual product that costs \$29 seen at CES. An app that goes with it makes sounds every time you pop open a bruski.



Real life angry birds

Spotted in one of the corners of the CES floor was an angry birds board game complete with an actual slingshot and bird/pig action figures.

Buzz

of AMD, that was bought by Qualcomm. In fact, 1.5 GHz parts have been sampled, and are market ready. We hope the mobile CPU market doesn't fall prey to the delusion of more-power-is-better, for there is no end to that roller-coaster ride.

So what does the MSM8660 do for us? And how exactly do two 1.2 GHz cores benefit your cell phone? How about 1080p video recording capability, and 1080p decoding ability along with the power to decode multiple-channel surround sound audio? Add to this a 5-inch, Super LCD display, and it's goodbye HDTV. Well, not quite, but this is heady stuff – we're being given more power in the palm of our hand, than our desktops had a mere six years ago. Snapdragon SoC already has baseband modem chips

inbuilt, saving on the need for third party silicon – an additional plus.

Qualcomm had a lot to show off about their new SoC. What followed was a barrage of physics-enabled games, video conferencing between multiple parties and high-definition stereoscopic 3D video – all to demonstrate the prowess of the two Scorpion cores and the Adreno 220. All of this was on display on a simple square handset, sans any frills. Obviously, this was just to showcase the hardware underneath the phone, before handset manufacturers design shells around this powerhouse. We should see the MSM8660 in action later this year, as several handset manufacturers will be itching to drop this into their devices. The MSM8260,

the same SoC design, minus the CDMA element, has already been announced for the ASUS Eee Pad Memo, a 7-inch tablet, running Android. Claims of better lower power consumption and therefore better battery performance (owing to two cores sharing the load and working less than a single core in the process) are extremely promising. More for less seems to have gotten everybody's attention. We'll be doing a feature on mobile computing, and where it's headed, in the near future – watch out for it.

iPad 2 case spotted at CES

Close on the heels of iPad 2 rumours doing the rounds of the tech world, an iPad 2 case was spotted at CES. Engadget managed to get some photo-

graphs of the alleged iPad 2 case which had housed a mockup iPad 2 within it. Dexim, which makes Apple accessories is the company behind this case. The case seems to confirm some rumours around the iPad 2 as it has a back facing as well as a front facing camera hole. The mockup iPad 2 was also found to be slightly thinner than the iPad that was offered to be placed in the case, thus confirming the rumour of a slimmer iPad 2.

The unique thing about the case is the ability to house a Bluetooth keyboard which



The purported iPad 2 case



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